

# Trend → Opportunity Funnel

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*From weak signal to validated bet*

## PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Trend-to-Opportunity Funnel is a staged filter that narrows a broad set of observed trends and weak signals down to a small set of validated opportunities worth investment.

## WHO DEVELOPED IT

A foresight-practice construct combining environmental scanning with stage-gate filtering, used in corporate-foresight and innovation pipelines.

## WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

It was developed to convert the noise of trend-watching into disciplined opportunity selection, avoiding both trend-chasing and paralysis.

FIGURE 1 · TREND → OPPORTUNITY FUNNEL

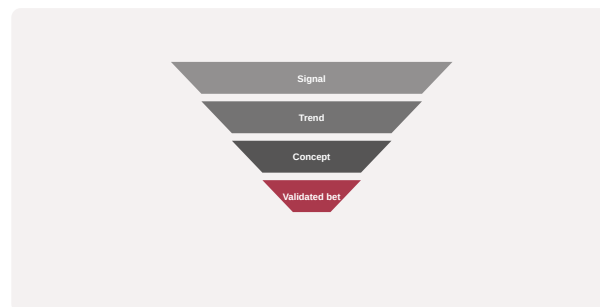


Figure 1. A schematic of the Trend → Opportunity Funnel as applied in BARBM312 (illustrative).

## HOW IT IS USED

Trends enter the wide mouth; each stage applies tests of relevance, feasibility and strategic fit until a few validated bets remain.

## WHEN IT IS USED

During innovation pipeline management and foresight-to-strategy translation.

## BY WHOM IT IS USED

Foresight, innovation and strategy teams.

## INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

It imposes selection discipline on foresight, linking trend detection directly to a fundable opportunity portfolio.

## RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

White-Space Map · Slibrary 4

Demand-Signal Radar · Slibrary 4

Blue Ocean Strategy Canvas · Slibrary 4

Three Horizons · Slibrary 4

## SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Rohrbeck, R. (2011) Corporate Foresight. Heidelberg: Physica-Verlag.

Cooper, R.G. (2008) 'Perspective: The Stage-Gate idea-to-launch process', Journal of Product Innovation Management, 25(3).